

Intro-Entertainment Industry

Questions

- How do you think you are currently perceived?
- How would you like to be perceived? What brand do you want to create?

Quote from The Actor's Business Plan (by Jane Drake Brody)

Each one of us is unique and it is that uniqueness that creates your brand.

- Brand includes many facets—it is not a type
- Coca-Cola is a brand that includes (Coke, Diet Coke, Sprite, Mr. Pibb, Classic Coke, Cherry Coke, etc.)
- Type is putting something or someone in a category

How Will You Be Typed Throughout Your Life?

- Whether you go into acting or not, people type you all the time
- Age, dialect, training, ethnicity, experience, teeth, attitudes toward life
- Why? Our brains are wired to think in categories

How Can You Work Typing to Your Advantage?

- Present yourself in the way you want to be perceived (e.g. if you want employers to think you're organized and responsible, iron your shirt before you show up at an interview, dress neatly, comb your hair)
- Be your authentic self (if you're proud of your tattoos, don't cover them up!)
- Directors, casting directors, employers do not often cast or hire people they want to "stretch"
- They hire people who fit the job—they hire PEOPLE
- Accept your limitations—see them as unique qualities to be exploited and adjusted to your advantage
- Don't expect employers or directors to work hard to see how to use you—show them

- The major lesson is that we are each unique because we are all human and we need to seek people and places where that uniqueness can be a plus.
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Surprises May Come

- Once you have clearly established your brand, you may be surprised to find people offering you opportunities that do not match the obvious “menu” you presented at first
- Why?
- You probably now come off as more confident and open—giving employers an opportunity to see you in many different lights

Things to Do to Increase Your Opportunities for Work

1. Maintain a database of all industry contacts (names, organization, dates interviewed/auditioned, outcomes, what you wore, etc.)
2. Maintain ongoing communication with industry contacts
3. Take classes and coaching (or ongoing professional development)
4. Be in shows (in any aspect of production); enter the companies you want to work for at the lowest level, if necessary; create your own videos/films; submit your reels directly (www.actorsaccess.com and www.castingnetworks.com frequently release casting calls where you can submit without an agent)